

Set up Perl on Windows 7



Most modern Linux distros are shipped with Perl. However, it needs to be installed on Windows. Perl is a high level programming language, and was written by Larry Wall and others. Because of its process, file and text manipulating facilities, it is popular with programmers. Here's a guide to setting up Perl on Windows 7.

Perl (Practical Extraction and Reporting Language) was developed by Larry Wall and has its roots in UNIX. Its inbuilt regular expressions engine, good execution speed, CPAN (Comprehensive Perl Archive Network) and, of course, the amazing Perl community, make it an ideal general-purpose programming language.

If you have Linux on your system, you are very likely to have some version of Perl, as well as an excellent tool chain such as gcc, make, etc. Windows users, however, are not so lucky. Perl has to be installed separately, and till a few years ago ActiveState Perl was the only option available.

Another issue was that a lot of applications that depended on Perl would install (mostly) older versions of Perl, and if you did not have admin rights to the Windows Server/workstation, there was just no easy way to install your own version of Perl. Even if you were very careful, you could very well end up messing up the pre-installed Perl.

That is exactly where Strawberry Portable Perl comes in.

What's Strawberry Perl?

It is a Perl environment for MS Windows containing all you need to run and develop Perl applications. It is designed to be as close as possible to the Perl environment on UNIX systems.

It includes Perl binaries, a compiler (gcc) + related tools, all the external libraries (crypto, graphics, xml, etc), a lot of really great modules pre-installed, cpanm - a nice utility that makes module installation easier, all the bundled

database clients, and a lot more.

In fact, the home page of Strawberry Perl has a statement from Larry Wall himself: "When I am on Windows, I use Strawberry Perl."

So let's begin. Here's what I have installed on my system:

```
C:\Users\pmu>perl -version
This is Perl 5, version 16, subversion 3 (v5.16.3) built for
MSWin32-x64-multi-thread
(with 1 registered patch, see perl -V for more detail)
Copyright 1987-2012, Larry Wall
Binary build 1603 [296746] provided by ActiveState http://
www.ActiveState.com
Built Mar 13 2013 13:31:10
Perl may be copied only under the terms of either the
Artistic License or the GNU General Public License, which may
be found in the Perl 5 source kit. Complete documentation
for Perl, including FAQ lists, should be found on this system
using "man perl" or "perldoc perl". If you have access to
the Internet, point your browser at http://www.perl.org/, the
Perl Home Page.
```

I installed this before I found Strawberry Perl and I let it be because, thanks to Strawberry Portable Perl, multiple versions of Perl can peacefully co-exist. I had encountered a similar situation on one of our SAN Management Servers. ActiveState Perl was pre-installed by another application which happened to use it for some heavy text manipulating